Nick
Baumgarten

LICENSED ARCHITECT · VICE PRESIDENT · PROJECT ARCHITECT
MULTISTUDIO · KANSAS CITY, MO

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LEE'S SUMMIT HIGH SCHOOL · PHOTOGRAPHY: MULTISTUDIO

01 PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I've spent thirteen years making buildings that carry memory, move people, and refine craft.

That work spans civic institutions, cultural landmarks, corporate campuses, schools, and hotels — built under the pressure of complex clients, compressed schedules, and competing agendas.

I'm a licensed architect and Vice President at Multistudio in Kansas City. I came up through Good Fulton & Farrell in Dallas, spent several years building the design side of a residential contractor's practice from the ground up, and have spent the last decade at Multistudio rising from intern to vice president.

What I bring to a project is both sides: the design conviction to push a building toward something worth building, and the operational discipline to negotiate fees, assemble teams, manage consultants, and hold a fast-track schedule without losing the thread of what the building is trying to say. I've done both on the same project — often in the same week.

The work in these pages extends across program types, scales, and degrees of complexity. What runs through all of it is a belief that buildings should earn their place — contextually, materially, culturally. That they should be legible to the people who use them. And that the distance between a good idea and a built building is where most of the real design work happens.

CURRENT POSITION

Vice President
Multistudio, Kansas City MO

LICENSURE

Licensed Architect - Missouri

EDUCATION

Master of Architecture
University of Kansas

Graduate Student
Kansas City Design Center

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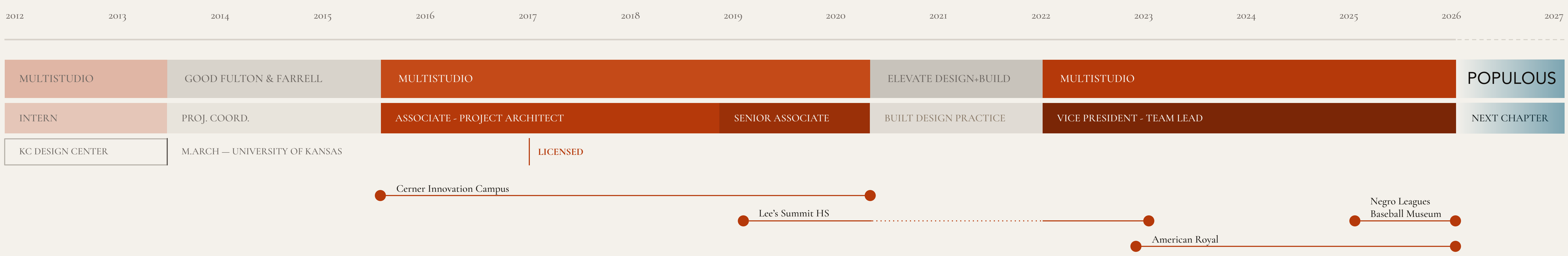
02 CAREER TIMELINE



13
Years in Practice

5
States

$1B+
Projects Executed

3
AIA Honor Awards

Lee’s Summit High School

Project Architect · Lee’s Summit, MO · 2019–2023

Lee's Summit High School was a building at a crossroads — a sprawling, aging campus serving one of Kansas City's largest student populations, its infrastructure failing and its spatial model rooted in an era when classrooms were sealed boxes and learning was a solitary act.

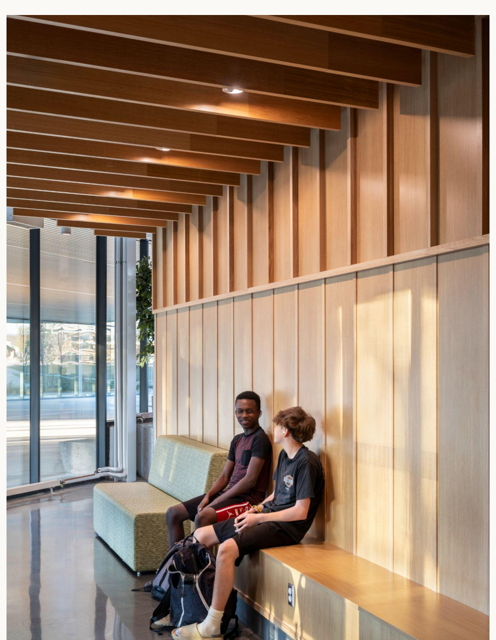
The renovation asked a harder question than simply what needed to be replaced. The answer was Innovation Way — a new glazed interior street threaded diagonally through the heart of the campus, connecting previously isolated wings and creating a series of collaborative learning nodes visible to one another across its full length. It isn't a corridor. It's a spine: the place where the school's different disciplines can see each other working.

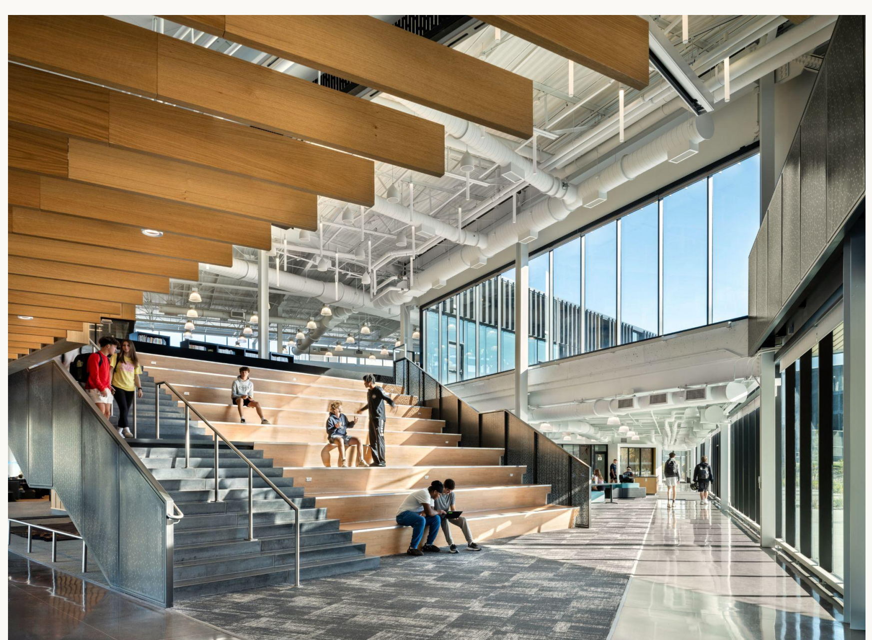
I served as Project Architect across the full scope — complete mechanical and envelope renewal, a significant academic addition, and the introduction of flexible classroom structures designed to dissolve the boundary between core instruction and vocational expertise. The brief called for outside professionals to step directly into the learning environment. The architecture was designed to make that feel natural rather than provisional.

What changed most is harder to measure than square footage or energy use: the school now has a center. Students and teachers move through a space that says learning is something you do together, in the open, where others can see you doing it.

AIA Kansas Chapter — Honor Award, Architectural Project: Urban
AIA Central States — Honor Award, Excellence in Architecture
AIA Kansas City Chapter — Honor Award, Architecture Extra Large

PROGRAM AREA	COST	STATUS
372,700 sf	$68M	Built





Innovation Way — the campus spine — makes learning visible across its full length of the school (right). Alcove seating offers respite without retreat (left); the academic stair extends that logic into open, informal gathering (center). Outside, a secured promenade runs parallel, carrying the same continuity under open sky (following page).

Negro Leagues Baseball Museum & Hotel

Project Manager · Kansas City, MO · *Currently in Construction Documents*

The 18th & Vine district is one of America's most significant cultural corridors — the birthplace of Kansas City jazz, home to the Negro Leagues, and a neighborhood whose story is inseparable from the history of segregation, resilience, and reinvention. After decades of divestment, it's experiencing a genuine second act. This project sits at the center of it.

The 18th & Paseo development is a multi-phase masterplan anchored by two buildings: the new home of the Negro Leagues Baseball Museum (33,000 sf) and the Pennant Hotel — a 144-key Marriott Tribute property — joined as a single hybrid structure at the most prominent corner of the district. Together, they form a gateway to 18th & Vine while preserving sightlines to the historic YMCA where the Negro Leagues were first chartered.

I served as Project Manager from Design Development through Construction Administration — responsible for negotiating the contract, assembling the consultant team, and authoring the multi-phase fast-track schedule for one of the more organizationally complex projects in the firm's recent history. Threading two clients, two programs, two interior design teams, Marriott brand standards, historic preservation requirements, and 18th & Vine design guidelines through a single core and shell required the schedule and the design to move together, not sequentially.

The architecture finds its footing in that complexity. Formed metal panels — their profile drawn from the geometry of a baseball bat — wrap the corner and establish the building's identity from a distance. Brick and precast concrete anchor it in the district's material vocabulary. A rooftop event deck takes its cues from stadium upper concourses: open, civic, oriented toward the neighborhood it belongs to. The building doesn't announce itself. It earns its place.

PROGRAM AREA

123,700 sf

COST

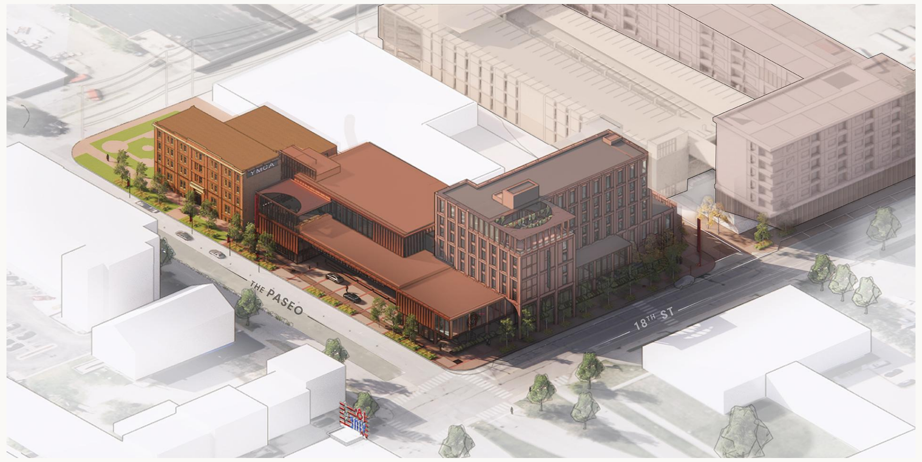
$71M

HOTEL KEYS

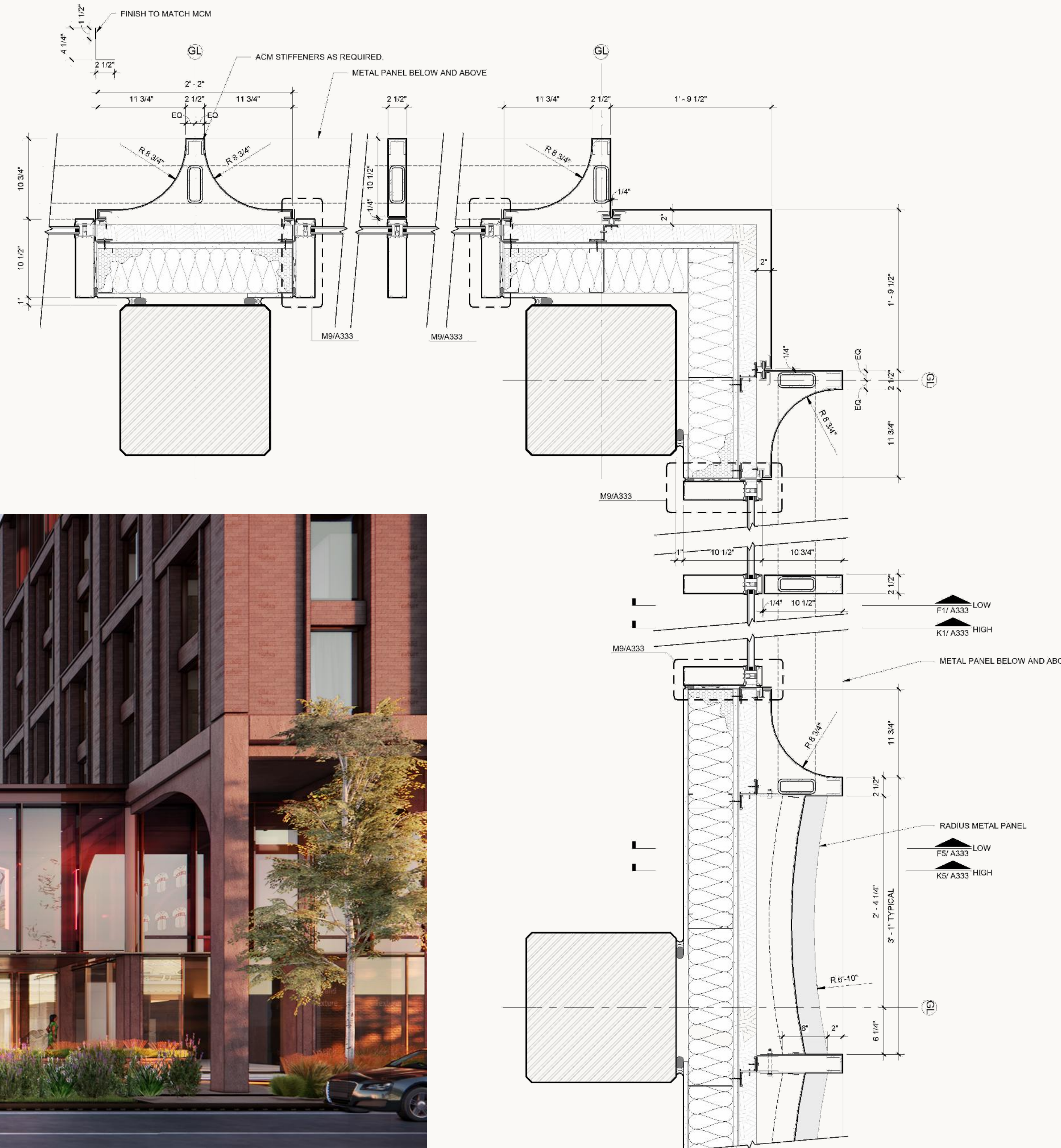
144

DELIVERY

Fast-Track Multi-Phase



The corner condition — where museum meets hotel, and both meet the district — resolved through a radius metal panel system whose profile is drawn from the geometry of a baseball bat (plan detail, right). Sightlines to the historic YMCA preserved in the site plan (above); the result at street level, where the building takes its place at 18th & Paseo (below).



American Royal

Senior Project Architect · Kansas City, KS · 2022–2026 - *Under Construction*

For 125 years, the American Royal called the West Bottoms home. When the institution relocated to the Legends District, the challenge wasn't to copy what had been left behind — it was to translate the honest vernacular of agricultural buildings into a world-class facility, without apology.

The solution is structural and material: five bays of pre-engineered metal building read, from the prairie edge, exactly like what they are — barns, at civic scale. Corrugated metal and exposed steel aren't treated as budget constraints here. They're the correct material language for a building about the American agricultural tradition, and they're detailed accordingly.

I served as Senior Project Architect from Schematic Design through Construction Administration, leading coordination across the full design-build team. The livestock barn interior pays direct homage to the West Bottoms stockyards. The education center — anchored by a demonstration kitchen — brings visitors into direct contact with food and agricultural production: the Royal's core civic mission, made spatial.

There's something right about a building that doesn't pretend to be something it isn't. The American Royal is exactly what it says it is — and that clarity of purpose is what gives it presence on the landscape.

TOTAL AREA	MAIN ARENA	COST	DELIVERY
1,000,000 sf	5,000 seats	$352M	Design-Build

Guests arrive beneath a dowel-laminated timber deck, a composed prairie landscape drawing them through the education center and demonstration kitchen before the arena opens beyond — arrival as procession, not threshold. The sequence is unhurried and intentional: the Royal's agricultural mission is experienced before it is witnessed (left). Throughout, the material palette never departs from its vernacular roots — corrugated metal, exposed steel, heavy timber — but each is handled with enough craft and precision to meet the scale and ceremony of the events held within (right). The barn's massive massing is broken down through the repetition of the traditional barn profile: five bays, each structurally legible, reading from the prairie edge exactly as intended. The building section below traces that logic from ground to ridge — structure as architecture, nothing concealed (below).

Cerner Innovation Campus

Project Architect · Kansas City, MO · 2014–2018

A million square feet of corporate workspace could easily become anonymous. The challenge at Cerner's Innovation Campus — the first phase of a 4.7-million-square-foot masterplan — was to build something that felt like a place worth belonging to, not just a building worth showing up to.

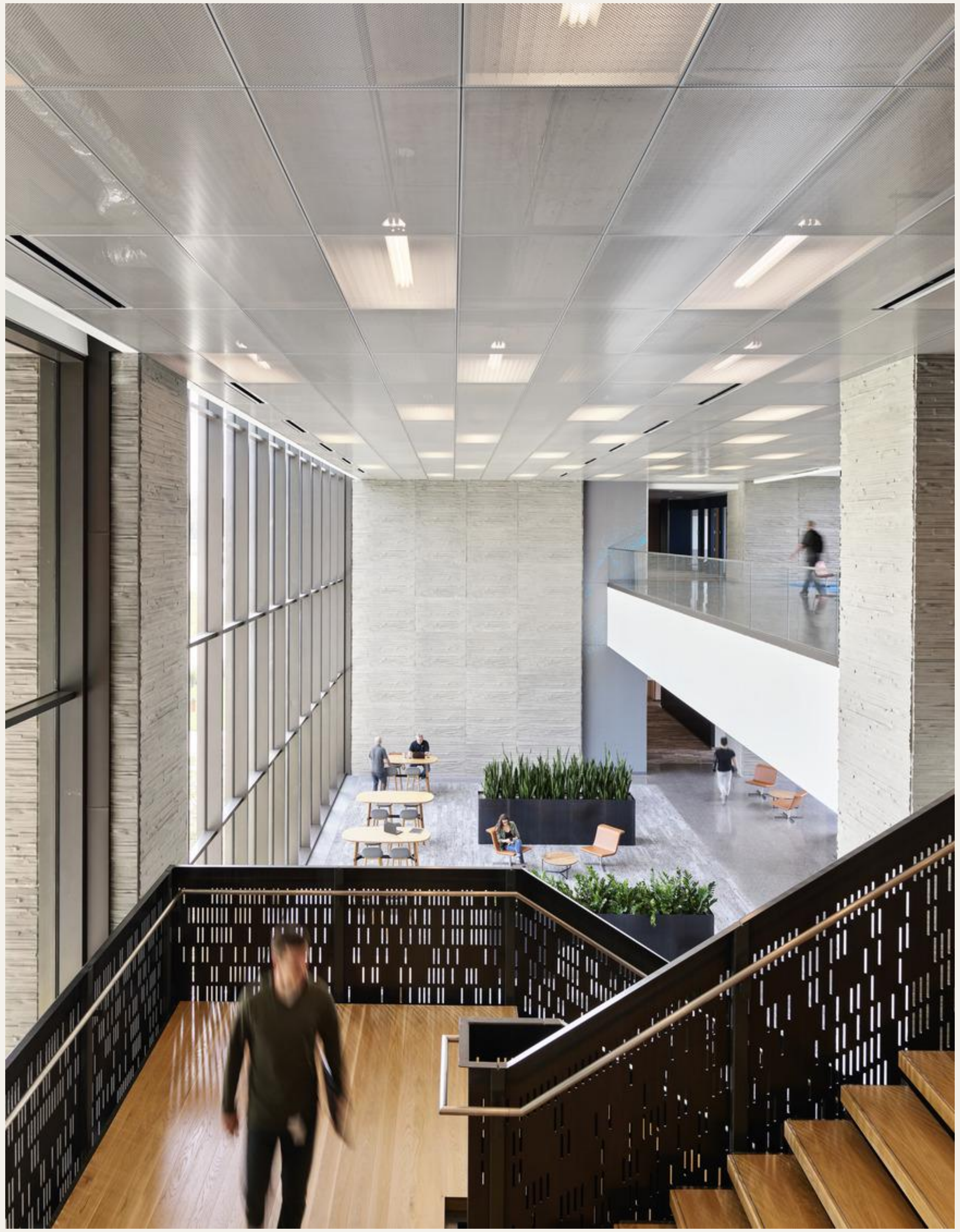
The campus is organized around a principle that resists the logic of most office development: that scale, handled correctly, doesn't have to erase the individual. Pairs of floors are grouped into neighborhoods, each joined by a connecting atrium — a "node" — that functions as a counterpoint to focused work. Somewhere between a town square and a landing pad, these nodes give the campus its social texture: a place to think out loud, to run into someone from a different team, to briefly resurface from deep concentration. The architecture is choreographing interaction without mandating it.

My scope focused on the technically complex detailing that gives the campus its specific identity. The element I'm most proud of is the feature entrance stair, repeated across multiple buildings. Working from the company founders' quotes, I translated the text into ASCII binary and used the resulting bit patterns to drive the perforation layout of the blackened metal panel railings. At a distance, the railing reads as pure industrial material — precisely detailed, quietly authoritative. Up close, it resolves into encoded meaning. The building is saying something. It just requires a certain kind of attention to hear it.

Because the perforation pattern was geometrically unique, a full-scale mockup was fabricated and tested to failure to confirm code compliance before a single panel went to fabrication. That process — from founders' words, to binary translation, to CNC perforation layout, to structural mockup, to confirmed performance — is the kind of problem I find most satisfying. It's where design conviction and technical rigor have to work in the same direction, at the same time. The stair is one detail in a campus of hundreds. But it's the one that tells you what the whole place believes about the people inside it.

CAMPUS AREA	COST	ROLE	STATUS
1,000,000 sf	$330M	SD — CA	Built

KCBJ 2018 Capstone Award — Judges Special Recognition
Concrete Promotional Group — Excellence in Concrete Award



The iridescent dichroic panels shift with angle and light — no two people standing in different positions see the same façade. It's an apt metaphor for a campus designed around individual experience: the building's identity, like the work inside it, changes depending on where you stand (previous page). Stainless steel cladding crowns the precast concrete base — a material dialogue between the natural science of healthcare and the precision of technology, the two disciplines the campus was built to unite (top right). The neighborhood nodes dissolve the anonymity of corporate scale into something more human — light-filled atriums where the boundaries between focused work and spontaneous exchange are left deliberately unclear (bottom right). The stair railing, read up close: founders' words encoded in binary, perforated into blackened metal — meaning embedded in material, legible only to those who look (left).

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Get in Touch

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